

Phrases to Lead Meetings in English

If you run meetings in English (or you need to learn these skills) this 'cheat sheet' is going to come in handy! It includes the exact phrases and expressions you will need to successfully host meetings in English - from start to end!

* **Print it out** and keep it next to you during your meetings so you can start putting them into practice!



STARTING YOUR MEETING

Greeting & Welcome

1. Hello everybody and welcome!
2. Good morning, I'd like to thank everyone for coming today.

Introductions

3. I see a few unfamiliar faces so, **let's do a round of introductions.**
 4. Before we get started, **let's go around the table and introduce ourselves.**
 5. [Professional Setting] Please say your name, role and company.
 6. [Social Setting] Tell us your name, where you're from and a fun fact about yourself.
- EXAMPLE:
7. I'm Emma from Perth, Western Australia and I have lived in every Australian city!

SET UP FOR SUCCESS

State the goal/purpose of the meeting

8. **Our goal today is to** plan the social media strategy for March and April.
9. **By the end of this session,** everyone will know how to use the new accounting software.
10. **We're here today to talk about** George Orwell's novel, 1984.

Outline the agenda

11. I'll just draw your attention to the agenda. We've got a few things to get through.

Signposting!

Discourse markers help explain the structure of the meeting.

12. **The first** item on the agenda is social media.

13. **Then**, we'll move on to item 2, which is customer satisfaction.

14. **After that**, we'll look at feedback from the community.

15. **And finally**, we'll discuss the new marketing strategy.

Set the ground rules

16. We have some **housekeeping** to get through first.

17. **Before we get started** could you all check that your phone is on silent or aeroplane mode?

18. **If you have any questions** outside of the agenda today, please save those until the end.

19. **If you have any questions** during our discussion today, use the 'raised hand' reaction.

20. **Feel free to share** your comments and questions in the chat.

21. Please put your microphones on mute **to keep disruptions to a minimum**.

MANAGE THE DISCUSSION

22. To kick things off, why don't we **brainstorm** a few ideas together.

Ask for opinions

23. What does everyone think?

24. **What are your thoughts on** the survey results?

25. I'd like to **get your input on** the new design.

26. What do you think, Amy?

Ask for clarification

- 27. Could you explain that in more detail?
- 28. Would you mind **going over** that again, please?
- 29. **What you're saying is**, it's not important how long the project takes, is that correct?
- 30. **If I understood correctly**, you're saying that these figures are incorrect.
- 31. **So in other words**, the report won't be finished on time.

Keep the meeting on track

- 32. If nobody has anything else to add, **let's move on** to the next item.
- 33. I'm sorry, but **I have to stop you there**.
- 34. We're running out of time, so **let's move on**.
- 35. I'm afraid we don't have time to discuss that in today's meeting. **Let's add it to next week's agenda**.

ENDING THE MEETING

Summarise

- 36. **Let me briefly summarise** what we've discussed today.
- 37. **We've agreed that** Aman will write the report.

Thank everyone and conclude

- 38. Thank you for your time and participation today.
- 39. **The next meeting is on** Tuesday, see you then.
- 40. Have a great day/week!